6. Booth numbers from ECI, 'Electors data summary', in *Uttar Pradesh General Legislative Election 2017*, 16 August 2018, https://eci.gov.in/files/file/3471-uttar-pradesh-general-legislative-election-2017/.
7. Interview with Dinesh Sharma, deputy chief minister, UP; former vice president, BJP; former BJP in-charge, Gujarat; and ex-mayor of Lucknow, 8 June 2020, Lucknow.
8. The Census of India 2011 counted 17,22,45,148 Muslims out of a total Indian population of 121,08,54,977. In UP, it counted 3,84,83,967 Muslims out of a total population of 19,98,12,341. Data from Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India, 'C1- Population by religious community', https://censusindia.gov.in/2011census/C-01.html.
9. Interview with Pranshu Sharma, UP bureau chief, Network18, 9–10 June 2020. BJP did win the Ayodhya seat (Faizabad) in the 1991 Lok Sabha elections.
10. In 1991, the BJP won 221 seats with 31.45 per cent of the votes. However, the INC had 17.32 per cent, the JD had 18.84 per cent, JP 12.52 per cent and BSP 9.44 per cent. The combined vote share of the last three pro-Mandal parties amounted to 40.8 per cent. Data from ECI, *Statistical Report on General Election, 1991, to the Legislative Assembly of Uttar Pradesh*, 14 August 2018, https://eci.gov.in/files/file/3257-uttar-pradesh-1991/.
11. Interview with a senior official in the UP chief minister's office, 9 June 2020, Lucknow.
12. Rajni Kothari, 'The Congress "system" in India', *Asian Survey*, Vol. 4, No. 12, Dec. 1964, pp. 1161–1173. On the Congress's one-party dominance, see W.H. Morris-Jones, 'Dominance and dissent: Their inter-relations in the Indian party system', *Government and Opposition*, Vol. 1, No. 4, August 1966 and W.H. Morris-Jones, 'The Indian Congress Party: A dilemma of dominance', *Modern Asian Studies*, Vol. 1, No. 2, 1967. Both essays are reproduced in W.H. Morris-Jones, *Politics Mainly Indian* (New Delhi: Orient Longman, 1978), pp. 213–265.